

Before using this, a good practice would be to first take a backup and then wipe the SD card.

To create a backup, you can run the following command:

```
dd if=/dev/[partition-to-wipe] of=/tmp/backup.img
```

Now you can wipe it as follows:

```
dd if=/dev/urandom of=/dev/[partition-to-wipe]
```

In case you need to restore the data back on the disk, you can use the command given below:

```
dd if=/tmp/backup.img of=/dev/[partition-to-wipe]
```

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Stop messing with my DNS!

 In Linux, entries for Domain Name Servers (DNS) are listed in the file `/etc/resolv.conf`

While DNS may be initially set manually or automatically, there are times when we do not want the system to alter them automatically. But making the file `resolv.conf` read-only with `chmod 555 resolv.conf` may not work.

In this situation, you can make `/etc/resolv.conf` truly read-only by issuing the following command:

```
sudo chattr +i /etc/resolv.conf
```

To revert the file to editable mode, issue the following two commands:

```
sudo chattr -i /etc/resolv.conf  
sudo chmod 777 /etc/resolv.conf
```

The parameter 777 would make the file writable by all. If this is not desirable then use the `chmod` as per your requirement.

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Notifying scripts

 Over the past few days, I have been searching for a way by which I could get notifications regarding the events occurring as a result of my scripts running in the background. Neither did I want to put my script in debug mode, i.e., execute my script using the `-x` option (`sh -x my_script.sh`), nor did I want to use any echo command. I just wanted a pop-up message that would appear on the occurrence of any event.

I soon came across `notify-send`, which completely fulfilled my needs. Now I can receive regular pop-up messages from scripts that respond to me whenever some event is generated. Normally, `notify-send` is installed in

nearly all the systems. If not and in case you want to install it manually, you just need to install `libnotify` package from your repositories. Ubuntu users can execute the following command to install `notify-send`:

```
apt-get install libnotify-bin
```

Once this is installed, you can directly use `notify-send` with your commands or within your scripts, and enjoy regular pop-up messages. For example, if you want a pop-up message of 'hello world', just give the following command:

```
notify-send Hello World
```

By default, the pop-up message would remain for five seconds, which you can change by using the `-t` switch (time entered would be in milliseconds). Enter `-t 0` in order to leave the message on the screen until the user closes it.

```
notify-send "Hello Harman How are you" -t 0
```

In this case, the user is expected to close the message. We can even have icons displayed in our pop-up messages, by simply using the `-i` switch, as follows:

```
notify-send "Hello" -i /path/of/image_file.png
```

Now let us implement an example script, which would pop up a message, after 24 hours, indicating the space used on your hard disk:

```
#!/bin/sh  
while [ 1 ] ;  
do  
    notify-send "$([ df -h | grep sda12 | awk '{print $1}' is "  
$5 " used" ])" -t 0 #/dev/sda12 is my hard disk  
  
    sleep 24h #sleep of 24 hours  
done  
exit 0
```

This is just an example of how to use `notify-send` in our script. You can try it yourself to explore more options.

—Harman Kalra,
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END

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